



Leading across Generations Managing Multigenerational Workforces

Group 9

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Introduction & Research Motivation

Today's corporate environment is made of a multigenerational workforce

Multinational and generally diverse work landscape



Research Question & Objectives

Research Question

How do corporate leaders navigate the challenges of managing multigenerational workforces?



Objective

Identify effective leadership style(s) for managing multigenerational teams and create a practical toolbox for managers and HR professionals.



Theoretical Background Research Articles

Theme One

Leadership Styles Across Generations

Veterans value hierarchical leadership, while millennials emphasize creativity and feedback, highlighting generational differences in leadership preferences.

Theme Two

Leadership Adaptability and Engagement

Veterans prefer structured, direct leadership, but younger generations like Gen Z demand flexibility and purpose-driven leadership.

Theme Three

Leadership Training and Organizational Success

Culturally tailored leadership strategies and technological adaptability are critical for organizational success across generational cohorts.

Theme Four

Leadership Communication and Cultural Fit

Older generations prefer indirect communication, whereas younger employees expect direct, real-time communication, requiring adaptable leadership approaches.

Main Insight

Successful leadership requires blending **transactional and transformational styles**, integrating **technology**, and fostering **cultural adaptability** to effectively engage and retain talent across a **multigenerational workforce**, ensuring flexibility without losing structured guidance.



Research Design & Field Selection & Netnography



Netnography



Online ethnographic research for studying digital communities.



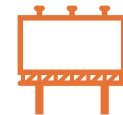
Interviews



Gathering in-depth insights through structured or semi-structured conversations.



Field Selection



Reddit: Communities with niche discussions (e.g., consumer experiences).



LinkedIn: Professional networks and industry insights.



Twitter: Real-time trends and public sentiment.

Methodology & Data Collection: Survey & Experiment Design, Data Analysis

Survey Design:	Experiment Design:	Data Collection:	Analysis:
Structured questions (open/closed) to capture user insights.	Control vs experimental group; testing hypotheses.	Netnographic scraping or manual collection.	Thematic analysis for qualitative data.
Distribution through online forms or email.	Variables: Independent & dependent.	Interview transcription & coding.	Descriptive stats & hypothesis testing for experiments (t-tests, ANOVA).

Netnography

Reddit

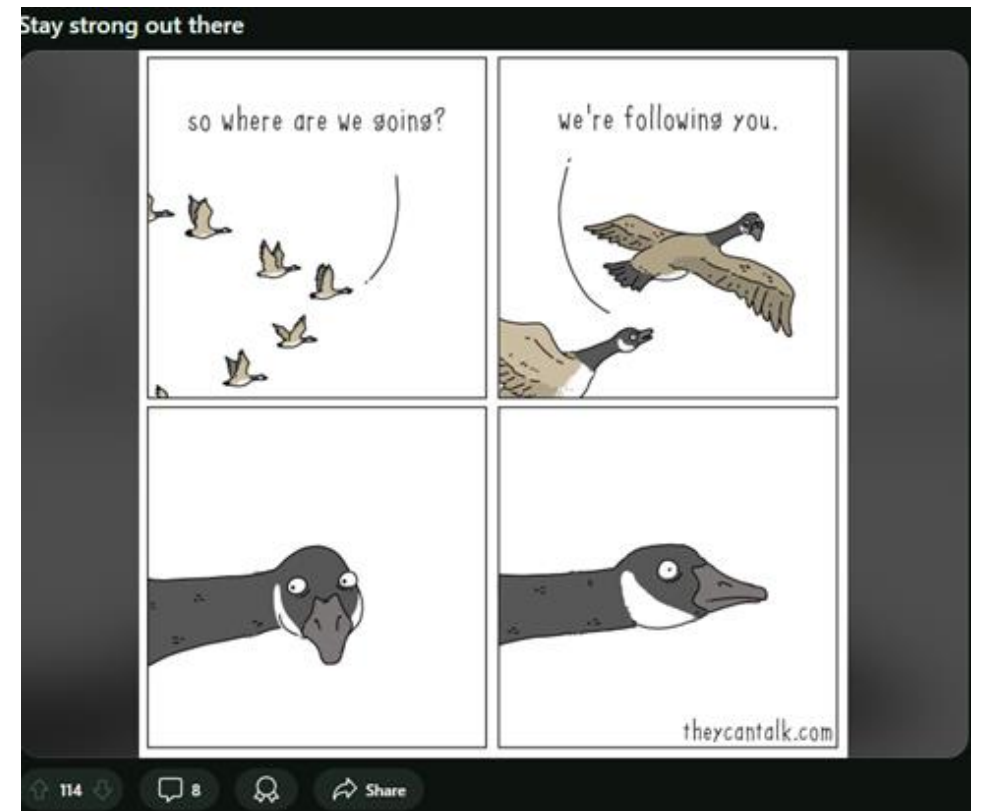
Main Findings

- **Leadership Adaptability:** Younger employees prefer autonomy, while older ones value structure. Balancing delegation with involvement is essential.
- **Communication Flexibility:** Generational differences in communication styles require adaptable strategies to minimize misunderstandings.
- **Emotional Complexity:** Managing relationships across generations can be emotionally demanding; setting boundaries helps avoid burnout.
- **Practical Implications:** Real-time challenges shared on Reddit highlight the need for empathetic, authentic leadership and communication flexibility.

General Information

Culture: Playful, critical, supporting.

Subreddits: R/Leadership - 53000 users is also in the top 3% reddit by size & R/CareerGuidance - 4 millions users also in the top 3%.



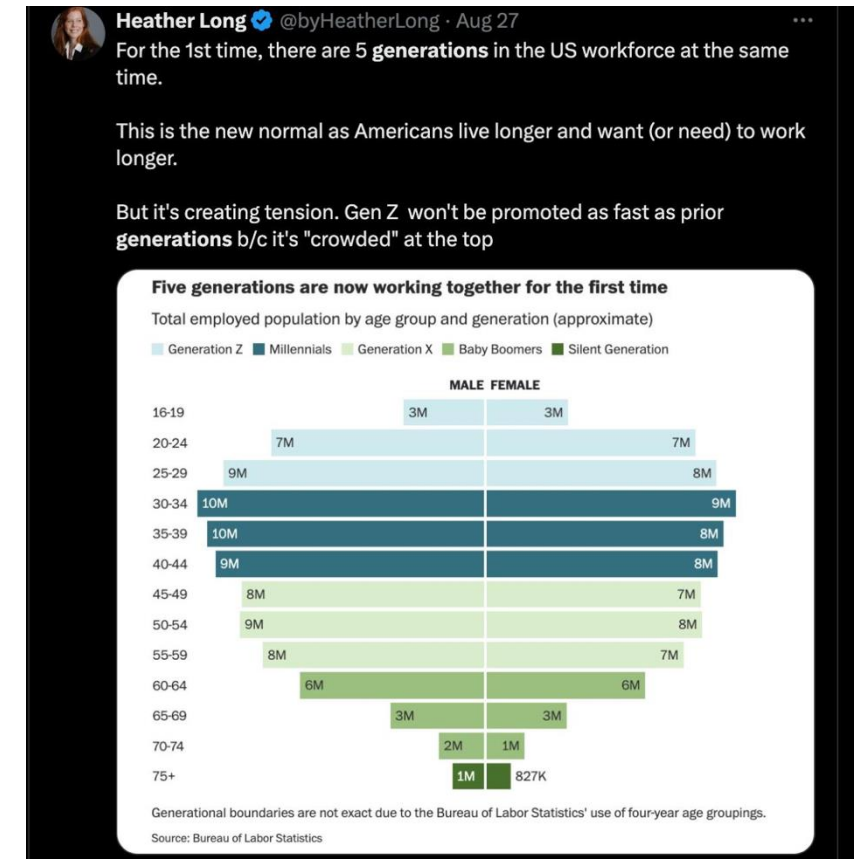
Netnography Twitter/X

Culture

- **Collaborative and supportive environment** for leadership discussions.
- Focuses on **empowering employees** through **autonomy** and **trust**.
- Promotes **real-time adaptability** in leadership, encouraging multigenerational collaboration.
- Hashtags like **#LeadershipWisdom** and **#TalentRetention** drive community engagement and leadership conversations.

Main Findings

- Leadership styles need to be **adaptive** to engage multigenerational teams.
- **Younger generations** prioritize **flexibility**, **creativity**, and **purpose-driven work**.
- **Trust-based leadership** is key for empowering employees and improving team performance.
- Effective leadership on Twitter emphasizes **openness**, **collaboration**, and **supportive feedback**.
- The platform promotes **real-time problem-solving** and **engagement** through open discussions on leadership best practices.



Netnography LinkedIn



Positive and Enthusiastic Environment

LinkedIn posts emphasize personal and professional growth.

Posts receive encouraging comments, example: "Well done!" and "Congrats".



Emphasis on Leadership and Growth

Posts share leadership content.

Posts revolve around improving oneself, mindset shifts, and skill-building.



Networking and Connection

Platform is heavily oriented towards building professional connections

Discussions around teamwork and collaboration



Diverse Perspectives on Leadership

Leaders from different industries bring diverse viewpoints on leadership

Posts often reflect on an international view of leadership -> with many people from various cultural backgrounds

**LEADERS WHO
SHINE FROM WITHIN
DON'T NEED THE
SPOTLIGHT**

JOSHUA MILLER • The On-Demand Coach
for the In-Demand Leader™



Indu Tripathi (She/Her) • 3rd+
Content Creator 🌟 || Helping Brands to grow 🌱 || LinkedIn Growth E...
Intriguing view on leadership, particularly the part about validation through team success & growth.

Like · 🗨️ 2 | Reply · 1 Reply



Joshua Miller (He/Him) **Author**
Master Certified Executive Leadership Coach | LinkedIn Top V...
[Indu Tripathi](#) Thank you!

Like | Reply



Kelly Mizell 🌟 • 3rd+
JLL - Jones Lang LaSalle - Senior General Manager
At the heart of every leader is a servant who is ready to uplift, empower and inspire!! Great message/post dear friend! I think we were in the same mindset this morning! Happy almost Friday [Joshua Miller](#)!! ❤️🌟

Like · 🗨️ 4 | Reply · 1 Reply



Joshua Miller (He/Him) **Author**
Master Certified Executive Leadership Coach | LinkedIn Top V...
[Kelly Mizell](#) 🌟❤️🥰🧠 — Happy Pre-Friday 🥳🙌

Like · 🗨️ 3 | Reply

Interview Overview Method and Questions

Interview Type: Semi-structured interviews with probing.

Focus: Communication, leadership strategies, challenges and work expectations in multigenerational teams.

Interviewees

Mutharasan: Middle Manager (IT Company) with 10 years of experience

Anthony: HRD (Local Government Agency)

Tugce: Business Leader (Advanced Technology Company)

Rishi: Deputy Manager (Bank)

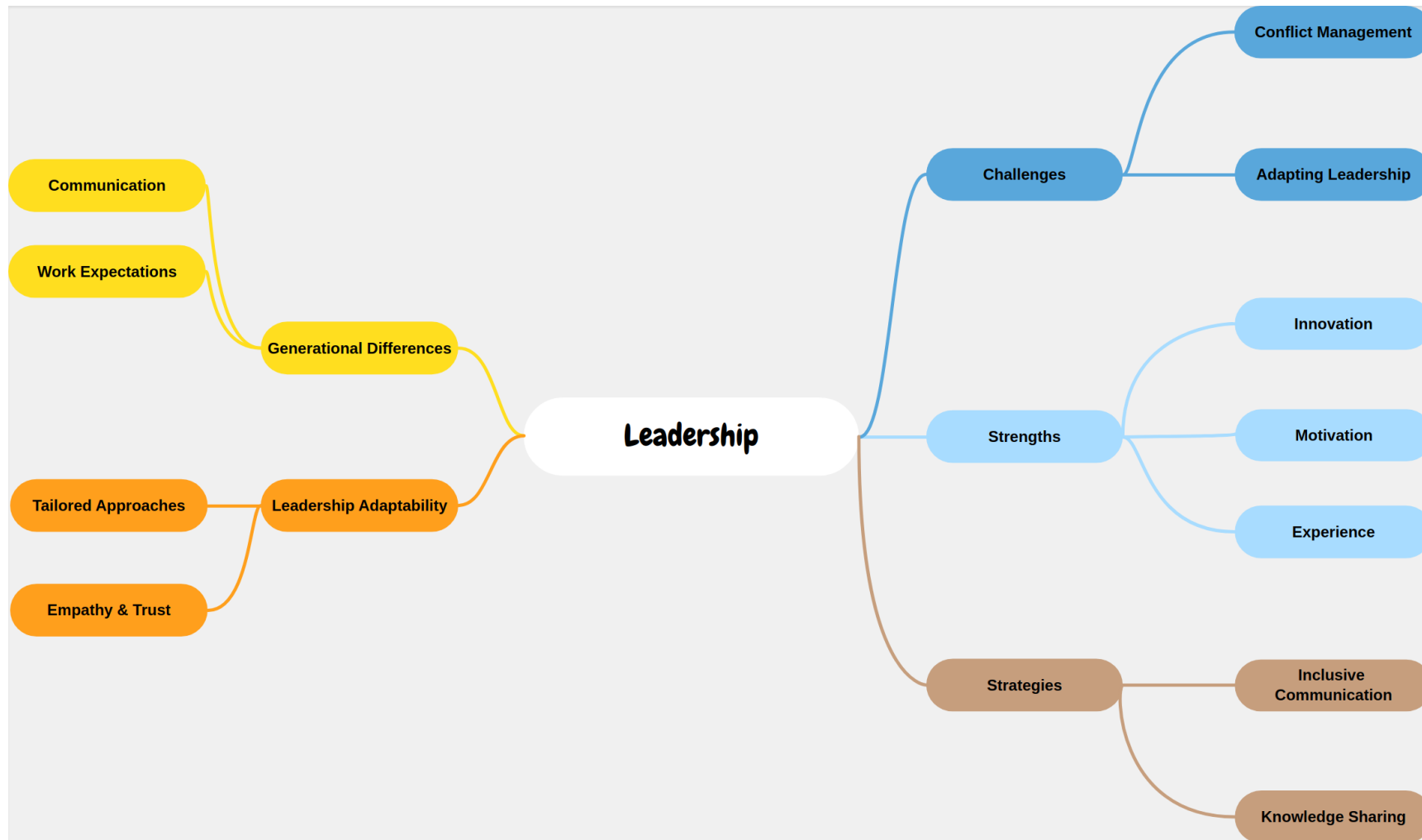
Hanxiang Yuan: Employee with multiple internships/work experiences (GlaxoSmithKline)

Key Insights

Challenges and Strengths: Generational differences impact communication and work expectations, offering both opportunities and challenges.

Leadership Strategies: Effective leaders adapt styles to accommodate generational dynamics, fostering inclusivity and motivation.

Interview Highlights



Results & Interpretation

Understanding Multigenerational Workforces

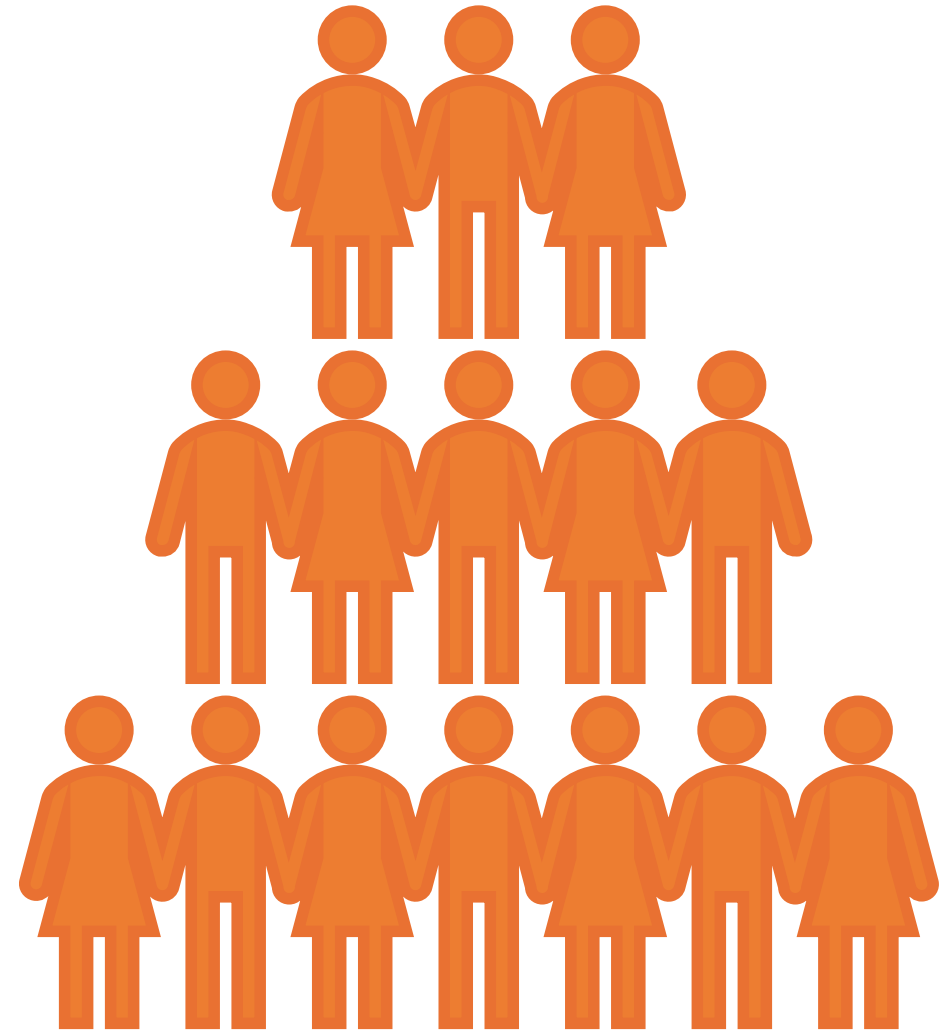
Team Composition & Diversity:

Managing teams with individuals aged 22-65, with varying years of experience (2-40 years) requires a tailored leadership approach.

Generational Priorities:

Younger Employees (Gen Z, Millennials): Focus on learning and career growth.

Older Employees (Gen X, Baby Boomers): Prioritize work-life balance and stability





Results & Interpretation

Leadership Across Generations

Challenges:

Communication & Professionalism: Maintain formal communication to avoid misunderstandings among generations.

Authority vs. Collaboration: Leaders must balance authority with collaboration.

Solutions:

Trust Building: Empathetic leadership fosters trust and inclusivity.

Feedback & Knowledge Sharing: Encourage continuous feedback loops; knowledge from younger employees (latest trends) and experienced leaders (wisdom) must be shared.

Results & Interpretation

Future Leadership for Multigenerational Teams

Key Approaches:

Empathy & Inclusivity: Leaders should create an environment where every generation feels valued.

Continuous Learning & Adaptability: Leaders must embrace constant learning to stay relevant in managing diverse teams.

Takeaways:

Leaders must recognize diverse motivations - financial, career growth, or stability - and adapt their leadership style accordingly.



Hypothesis

Corporate leaders who adapt transformational leadership styles are more successful in managing multigenerational workforces compared to those who use transactional leadership styles.

Transformational leadership style:

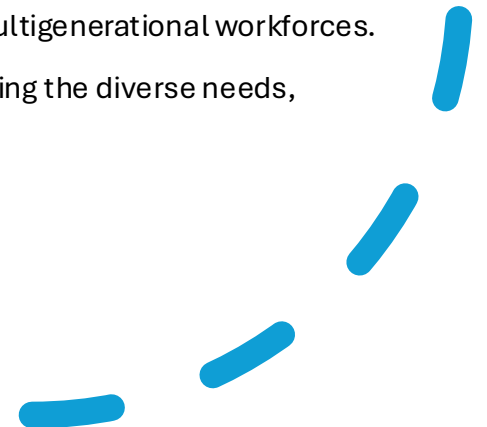
- A leadership approach that focuses on inspiring and motivating employees to exceed expectations.
- Emphasizes vision, communication, innovation, and personal development.
- Leaders encourage collaboration and trust, and seek to elevate the potential of their employees.

Transactional leadership style:

- A leadership approach that is more focused on maintaining routine operations.
- Based on exchanges or rewards/punishments for performance.
- Focuses on achieving short-term tasks and objectives.

Hypothesis claim:

- Leaders who use transformational leadership are better at managing multigenerational workforces.
- This implies that transformational leaders are more effective in addressing the diverse needs, motivations, and working styles of different generations.



Sampling Method for Our Research

Sampling Method: Stratified Sampling

Why Stratified Sampling?

To explore how corporate leaders manage multigenerational workforces, we ensured representation across leadership styles.

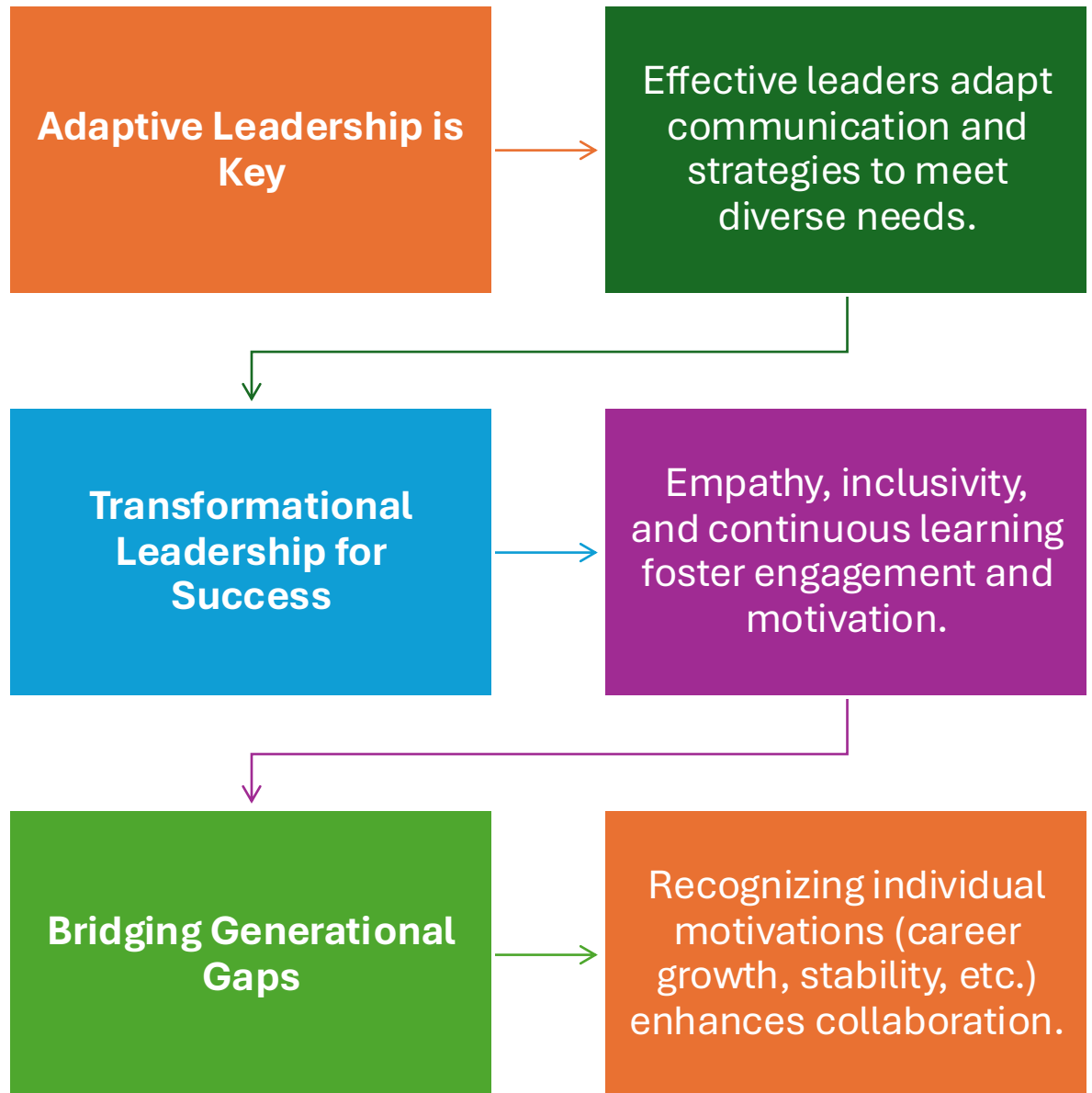
Stratification Based on Leadership Types

The sample was divided by leadership styles (e.g., Transformational, Transactional) to capture diverse perspectives.

Research Benefit

This approach offers insights into how different leadership styles impact generational work preferences and productivity, helping tailor strategies for managing multigenerational teams.

Conclusions & Implications



Thank You!

Questions/Feedback



References

Molek, Nadia, et al. "Leadership styles and generational differences in manufacturing and service organizations." *Organizacija* 56.3 (2023): 221-232.

Salahuddin, Mecca M. "Generational differences impact on leadership style and organizational success." *Journal of Diversity Management* 5.2 (2010): 1.